

Word family: ****commercial / commercially / commercialize / commercialise / commercialization / commercialisation / commercialism / non-commercial****

****Base word:** commercial**

****Related forms:** commercially, commercialize/commercialise, commercialization/commercialisation, commercialism**

****Useful opposite/contrast:** non-commercial**

****Common extensions:** TV commercial, commercial break, commercial success, commercial property, commercial vehicle, commercial use, commercially viable**

****Part of speech:** noun(名詞) / adjective(形容詞)**

Your sentence:

> “One advertisement that persuaded me to buy a product was a TV ****commercial**** for a pair of noise-cancelling headphones.”

A full family sweep shows that ****commercial**** has two major modern cores:

1. ****a paid advertisement, especially on television/radio/video****
2. ****connected with business, buying/selling, or making profit****

Those are genuinely distinct enough to teach separately.

Meaning in this passage

Here, ****commercial**** is a ****noun**** meaning:

****a paid advertisement broadcast on television, radio, or similar media in order to promote a product, service, or brand.****

****繁體中文:** **為推廣產品、服務或品牌而製作並在電視、電台或其他影音媒體播放的付費商業廣告****

Natural translation:

> “a TV commercial for a pair of noise-cancelling headphones”

「一則關於降噪耳機的****電視商業廣告****」

In natural Chinese, simply:

****TV commercial = 電視廣告****

1. **commercial = television/radio/video advertisement (媒體廣告) — 商業廣告; 廣告**

This is your original meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I saw a TV **commercial** for noise-cancelling headphones.”

「我看到一則關於降噪耳機的**電視廣告**。」

Practice 2

> “The company launched a new **commercial** during the sports broadcast.”

「公司在體育賽事轉播期間推出了一則新的**商業廣告**。」

Practice 3

> “That **commercial** made the product look very appealing.”

「那則**廣告**令產品看起來很吸引。」

****commercial — noun = 為推廣產品、服務或品牌而播放的商業宣傳廣告****

2. **commercial = related to business/trade (商業／貿易) — 商業的; 商務的**

Here, **commercial** is an adjective.

****Meaning:**** Connected with business, trade, buying, selling, or economic activity.

Practice 4

> “The building is used for **commercial** purposes.”

「這棟建築物用作**商業用途**。」

Practice 5

> “The area contains both residential and **commercial** buildings.”

「這個地區同時有住宅和**商業建築**。」

****commercial = 與企業經營、買賣、貿易或商業活動有關的****

Common:

* commercial activity = 商業活動

* commercial district = 商業區

* commercial property = 商業物業

* commercial law = 商法

3. ****commercial = intended to make money/profit(盈利目的) — 商業性的; 以盈利為目的的****

This is closely related to #2, but the emphasis is specifically on ****profit-making****.

Practice 6

> “The project has both artistic and ****commercial**** goals.”

「這個項目同時有藝術目標和****商業盈利目標****。」

Practice 7

> “The software is free for personal use but not for ****commercial**** use.”

「這套軟件可免費作個人用途, 但不可免費用於****商業用途／盈利用途****。」

****commercial = 以賺取收入或盈利為目的, 而非純個人、慈善、研究或非牟利用途****

4. ****commercial success(產品／電影／作品) — 商業成功; 市場上賺錢成功****

A very useful expression.

Practice 8

> “The film was a major ****commercial success****.”

「這部電影在市場上取得很大的****商業成功****。」

Practice 9

> “The product received mixed reviews but became a ****commercial success****.”

「這件產品評價褒貶不一，但最終取得了**市場上的商業成功**。」

****commercial success = 產品、作品或服務在銷售、收入或盈利方面取得成功****

Important:

A film can be:

> ****a critical success but a commercial failure****

= ****影評很好，但票房／商業表現失敗****

So ****commercial success**** is not the same as “high quality.”

5. ****commercial failure (市場表現) — 商業失敗; 銷售／票房失利****

Practice 10

> “The device was innovative but a ****commercial failure****.”

「這部裝置雖然創新，但在市場上是一次****商業失敗****。」

Practice 11

> “The film became a ****commercial failure**** despite strong reviews.”

「雖然影評很好，這部電影仍然在票房上****商業失利****。」

****commercial failure = 在收入、銷售、票房或盈利方面未能取得成功****

6. ****commercial = suitable for / used by businesses (企業使用) — 商用的; 商業級的****

****Meaning:**** Designed or intended for use in business rather than ordinary private/domestic use.

Practice 12

> “The kitchen uses ****commercial**** ovens.”

「這個廚房使用****商用焗爐****。」

Practice 13

> “They bought a **commercial** coffee machine for the café.”

「他們為咖啡店購買了一部**商用咖啡機**。」

commercial equipment = 為企業、店舖或高使用量環境而設計的商用設備

Often implies heavier-duty or larger-scale use than consumer/home equipment.

7. **commercial vehicle**(運輸) — 商用車輛

Practice 14

> “The company operates a fleet of **commercial vehicles**.”

「公司營運一支**商用車隊**。」

Practice 15

> “Different rules may apply to **commercial vehicles**.”

「**商用車輛**可能適用不同規則。」

commercial vehicle = 主要用於運送貨物、乘客或商業工作, 而非私人日常用途的車輛

8. **commercial property/real estate**(物業) — 商業物業; 商用房地產

Practice 16

> “The firm invests in **commercial property**.”

「這間公司投資**商業物業**。」

Practice 17

> “Office buildings are a form of **commercial real estate**.”

「辦公大樓屬於**商業房地產**的一種。」

****commercial property = 用於辦公、零售、工業等商業活動的物業****

9. ****commercial = popular/mainstream rather than purely artistic (音樂／電影／藝術) — 商業化取向的; 迎合大眾市場的****

This is an important evaluative/contextual use.

****Meaning:**** Designed to appeal to a broad audience and sell well, sometimes contrasted with experimental or artistic work.

Practice 18

> “The album has a more ****commercial**** sound than their earlier work.”

「這張專輯的音樂風格比他們早期作品****更迎合大眾市場、更具商業取向****。」

Practice 19

> “The director wanted the film to be artistic without becoming too ****commercial****.”

「導演希望電影保留藝術性, 而不要變得過分****商業化／迎合市場****。」

****commercial — creative work = 以大眾接受度和市場銷售為重要考慮的****

This can be neutral or mildly negative depending on tone.

10. ****commercial break (電視／電台) — 廣告時段****

A highly useful fixed expression.

Practice 20

> “I made some tea during the ****commercial break****.”

「我在****廣告時段****去泡了茶。」

Practice 21

> “The programme returned after a short ****commercial break****.”

「節目在短暫的**廣告時段**後恢復播放。」

commercial break = 電視或電台節目暫停、插播商業廣告的一段時間

11. **commercially = in business/profit terms — 從商業角度; 在市場上**

Practice 22

> “The product performed well **commercially**.”

「這件產品在**商業／市場表現方面**很好。」

Practice 23

> “The idea is creative but may not work **commercially**.”

「這個構思很有創意, 但從**商業角度**未必可行。」

commercially = 從銷售、收入、市場或盈利的角度而言

12. **commercially successful — 商業上成功的; 市場表現成功的**

Practice 24

> “The game was both critically praised and **commercially successful**.”

「這款遊戲既獲得好評, 也在**商業上取得成功**。」

Practice 25

> “Not every innovative product becomes **commercially successful**.”

「並非每件創新產品都能在**市場上取得商業成功**。」

commercially successful = 在銷售、收入或盈利方面取得良好成果的

13. **commercially viable (產品／計劃) — 商業上可行的; 有盈利可能的**

Very important in business English.

Practice 26

> “The technology works, but it is not yet **commercially viable**.”

「這項技術雖然可行，但目前在**商業上仍未具備盈利可行性**。」

Practice 27

> “The company is looking for a **commercially viable** solution.”

「公司正在尋找一個**在成本和市場上可持續運作的解決方案**。」

commercially viable = 有足夠市場需求和合理成本，使產品／計劃有實際盈利可能的

14. **commercialize / commercialise** = turn something into a profit-making product/business — 商業化；商品化

Meaning: To develop or use an idea, invention, activity, etc. in order to sell it and make money from it.

Practice 28

> “The company hopes to **commercialize** the technology.”

「公司希望把這項技術**商業化並推出市場**。」

Practice 29

> “Researchers developed the invention, and a private firm later **commercialised** it.”

「研究人員開發了這項發明，後來由私人企業把它**商品化／商業化**。」

commercialize = 把原本的技術、構思、活動或文化內容轉化成可在市場出售並盈利的產品／服務

Spelling:

* **commercialize** = common American spelling

* **commercialise** = common British spelling

15. **commercialization / commercialisation** = process of becoming commercial — 商業化；商品化過程

Practice 30

> “The **commercialization** of the technology took several years.”

「這項技術的**商業化過程**花了數年。」

Practice 31

> “Some people criticized the **commercialisation** of the festival.”

「有些人批評這個節日變得過度**商業化**。」

commercialization = 把某項技術、活動、文化或創意變成以市場和盈利為導向的過程

16. **commercialism** = excessive emphasis on business/profit — 商業主義; 過度追求商業利益

This is a distinct and useful family extension.

Practice 32

> “Critics complained about the growing **commercialism** of the event.”

「批評者抱怨活動愈來愈充滿**商業主義／逐利色彩**。」

Practice 33

> “The festival tries to avoid excessive **commercialism**.”

「這個節日嘗試避免過度的**商業化和逐利取向**。」

commercialism = 過度重視銷售、盈利和商業利益, 令其他價值被削弱的傾向

This is usually negative.

17. **non-commercial** = not primarily intended to make profit — 非商業的; 非牟利用途的

Practice 34

> “The images may be used for **non-commercial** purposes.”

「這些圖片可用於**非商業／非牟利用途**。」

Practice 35

> “The station is funded as a **non-commercial** broadcaster.”

「這個電台以**非商業廣播機構**形式獲得資助。」

non-commercial = 主要目的不是出售產品、做生意或取得盈利的**

Important distinction: **commercial vs advertisement**

In your original sentence:

advertisement / ad

is the broad category.

commercial

usually refers specifically to a broadcast/video/audio advertisement, especially TV or radio.

So:

> **TV commercial** 

> **newspaper commercial**  normally

For a newspaper:

> **newspaper advertisement / ad**

Important distinction: **commercial vs marketing**

commercial

as a noun:

= one specific advertisement.

marketing

= the broader process of understanding customers and promoting/selling products.

> “The commercial was part of the company’s marketing campaign.”

「這則廣告是公司市場推廣活動的一部分。」

So:

commercial = 一則廣告

marketing = 整體市場推廣活動／策略

Important distinction: **commercial vs business**

They overlap, but:

business

is broader and can refer to:

* a company

* commercial activity

* one's work affairs

commercial

more specifically means connected with trade, markets, sales, or profit.

> “business decision”

= 商業／企業決策

> “commercial success”

= 市場盈利方面的成功

Important distinction: **commercial vs industrial**

commercial

= business, trade, sales, services

industrial

= manufacturing, factories, heavy production

> commercial district

> = 商業區

> industrial district

> = 工業區

Important distinction: **commercial vs residential**

Especially useful for buildings/property.

commercial

= used for business

residential

= used for people to live in

> commercial property

> = 商業物業

> residential property

> = 住宅物業

Important distinction: **commercial vs profitable**

commercial

means connected with profit-making/business.

profitable

means actually making a profit.

A project can be:

> **commercial but not profitable**

= 是商業項目，但仍然不賺錢。

So the two are not synonyms.

Important distinction: **commercial vs commercialized**

commercial

= already related to business/profit.

commercialized

= changed into something more market/profit-oriented.

> “a commercial event”

「商業活動」

> “an increasingly commercialized festival”

「愈來愈商業化的節日」

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern family includes:

* **commercial — noun** = 電視／電台／影音商業廣告

* **commercial — business** = 商業的／商務的

* **commercial — profit-oriented** = 以盈利為目的的

* **commercial — business equipment** = 商用的

* **commercial success/failure** = 商業成功／失敗

* **commercial property** = 商業物業

* **commercial vehicle** = 商用車輛

* **commercial — creative work** = 迎合大眾市場、商業取向的

* **commercial break** = 廣告時段

* **commercially** = 從商業／市場角度
 * **commercially successful** = 商業上成功
 * **commercially viable** = 商業上可行、有盈利可能
 * **commercialize/commercialise** = 商業化／商品化
 * **commercialization/commercialisation** = 商業化過程
 * **commercialism** = 商業主義／過度逐利
 * **non-commercial** = 非商業／非牟利的

A close historical relative is **commerce**, but I would treat **commerce** as a neighbouring lexical family rather than simply another form of **commercial**, because modern learners encounter it as an independent noun meaning **trade/business activity**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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commercial — noun	為推廣產品、服務或品牌而在電視、電台或影音媒體播放的商業廣告
commercial — business/trade	與企業經營、買賣、貿易或市場活動有關的
commercial — profit-oriented	以取得收入或盈利為主要目的的
commercial — business equipment	為企業或高使用量商業環境而設計的
commercial success	產品或作品在銷售、票房、收入或盈利方面取得成功
commercial failure	產品或作品在市場收入／盈利方面未能成功
commercial — creative work	以大眾接受度和市場銷售為重要考慮、較迎合市場的
commercial break	節目中斷並播放商業廣告的一段時間
commercially	從市場、銷售、收入或盈利角度而言
commercially viable	市場需求和成本條件足以支持實際盈利運作的
commercialize	把技術、構思或活動轉化成可在市場出售並盈利的產品／服務
commercialization	某事物逐步轉變為市場和盈利導向的過程
commercialism	過度重視銷售、盈利和商業利益的傾向
non-commercial	主要目的不是出售產品、做生意或取得盈利的

For your original sentence

> “One advertisement that persuaded me to buy a product was a TV **commercial** for a pair of noise-cancelling headphones.”

The exact meaning is:

commercial = 一則為推廣和銷售產品而在電視上播放的商業廣告

So:

> **TV commercial**

= **電視廣告**

Here **commercial** is a **noun**, not the adjective meaning **「商業的」